

ACTIVITY 15 — FACILITATOR GUIDE**RACI Responsibility Assignment Matrix and Resource Plan**

TYPE	DURATION	MAPS TO	TOPIC
Workshop	45 minutes	LO2	4 - Lead the Project Team

Purpose of this activity

By the end of this activity learners will be able to assign R, A, C and I precisely, and defend every assignment against the one-accountable rule.

What learners produce

raci matrix, resource plan, raci issues — submitted to artifacts/.

Materials required

- Learner Worksheet (one per learner)
- Checklist (one per group)
- The Project Management Templates pack (see the Activities folder)
- Flipchart or A3 sheet and markers
- Laptop with internet access for the live problem-solving tools
- The course slides for the framework and worked example

Set-up

Groups of 3 to 4. Distribute one worksheet per learner and one checklist per group; each group needs one laptop for the calculations.

Scenario / briefing material

Contoso Learning Pte Ltd is a training provider with 14,000 active learners. Its course registration portal is 9 years old. Registration takes a median of 11 minutes and 34% of attempts are abandoned. Learner communications consume 24 staff-hours per week across 3 administrators. 62% of learner traffic is mobile, against a portal that is not responsive. Legacy consent screens do not meet current PDPA requirements. The project modernises course registration and learner communications.

How to run it — step by step

#	Instruction to learners	Facilitator note
1	Assemble the inputs. A RACI is derived, not invented. Confirm you have each input before you draw a single letter.	Keep role-holders in role; learners drift to consensus. Push for the concern behind the stated position.
2	Draft the matrix (this draft contains deliberate defects). Below is the first-draft RACI as a real project team would produce it in a 40-minute workshop. It covers 20 rows drawn from the Lab 11 WBS plus four cross-cutting process rows. It contains five structural defects. Do not fix them yet - Step 3 is the audit.	Pick one entry and follow it back to its source document. Broken traces surface immediately.
3	Enter it in the live RACI tool. Open RACI Matrix and build the matrix so the tool can run the structural checks	Debrief on what was conceded and why — the trade, not the outcome, is the learning.

	for you.	
4	Audit the matrix and find the five defects. This is the real learning in this lab. A RACI is only worth building if you then interrogate it. Run the five checks in order.	Keep role-holders in role; learners drift to consensus. Push for the concern behind the stated position.
5	Before and after, in numbers. The audit must produce a measurable change, or it was a discussion rather than an audit.	Pick one entry and follow it back to its source document. Broken traces surface immediately.
6	Build the resource plan and histogram. Create artifacts/15-resource-plan.md. The RACI says who; the resource plan says how much and when.	If a group finishes early, ask what changes at twice the scale or half the budget.
7	Level or smooth: the distinction the exam tests. Now work both remedies against the real BA over-allocation.	Check the arithmetic on one group's numbers before moving on — a wrong sign propagates into every later step.
8	Connect the RACI to the communication plan. Every C and every I in the matrix is a promise to communicate. Lab 18 has to schedule and staff those promises, so count them now.	Make a group state the UNITS and the base date. Most errors here are unit errors, not maths errors.
9	Answer the exam-style scenarios	Ask for one item the group nearly dropped and what made them keep it.

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
4 min	Brief the scenario, confirm the inputs and assign roles
17 min	Work the first half of the steps individually, then pool as a group
17 min	Complete the remaining steps and finalise the deliverable
7 min	Group share-back, facilitator debrief and exam-style linkage

Total: 45 minutes

Discussion & decision prompts

1. Assign R, A, C and I precisely, and defend every assignment against the one-accountable rule — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
2. Build a real responsibility assignment matrix from the Lab 11 WBS, using the live RACI tool — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
3. Audit a matrix for the five structural defects that make a RACI useless, and fix them — how did your group decide, and what would change that decision?
4. Every one of your 25 rows has exactly one A and at least one R. Count them; do not assume — can every member of your group defend it?
5. Where would raci responsibility assignment matrix and resource plan have saved you time or money on a real project you have worked on?

What good looks like

- Every one of your 25 rows has exactly one A and at least one R. Count them; do not assume.
- You resolved the two-A defect on the compliance evidence pack by SPLITTING the task, not by demoting the DPO or the PM to C.
- You found the row with no R, and you can say why that row belonged to the dependent stakeholders from Lab 07 rather than to anyone powerful.
- Your R-per-column count identified the BA at 14 of 24 rows, and you connected that to the Lab 16 storming diagnosis as a structural cause rather than a behavioural one.

- You challenged every C with the question "would their input change the work?" and you demoted at least one C to I with a stated reason.
- Your resource histogram has an explicit capacity line and you stated the total demand (320 hours) against total capacity (288 hours) before choosing a remedy.
- You can state, without looking it up, that levelling can change the critical path and extend the end date while smoothing works within float and cannot.
- You rejected levelling for Contoso on the specific ground that it pushes the G1 design baseline and therefore the critical path past the immovable 30 June date in constraint CON-1.